

READING

Do you love where you live? Why/Why not?

How can a building be environmentally friendly?

Where in the world can you live on the top floor of a 111-metre high-rise building, near the centre of a **lively** city, but still have breakfast under a tree on your balcony? Sounds almost impossible! Well, not if you live in the Bosco Verticale (vertical forest) buildings in Milan, Italy. Architect Stefano Boeri has created a completely new approach to designing buildings.

Like many big cities, Milan is **noisy** and **polluted**. It's hot in the summer and in the city centre the green spaces are often quite **crowded**. But Boeri's team have found a very green answer to these problems.

Nearly 900 trees grow high above Milan on the balconies of modern buildings. The trees keep the apartments cool in summer and warm in winter. They also produce oxygen, which keeps the air **clean**. The buildings are so **quiet** because the trees and plants stop the noise from the people and traffic in the streets below.

Bosco Verticale is really **convenient** for the city's shops, services and transport, it's **attractive**, and it's environmentally friendly. So, will there be more buildings like this in the future? Well, possibly. The architects want to build a new forest city in China and the Netherlands, but there is one more problem to solve. Buildings like this are **extremely** expensive. At 65 million euros, Bosco Verticale cost 5 per cent more to build than a normal high-rise building. But if we want to live in cool, quiet cities with clean air, it will be worth the cost.

Read *The forest in the sky* quickly and complete the sentences with the correct word or number from the text.

1. Bosco Verticale is an Italian name that means 'vertical _____.'
2. The apartment buildings are in the city of _____, in Italy.
3. There are nearly _____ trees on the balconies on the buildings.
4. The plants help make the noise from the _____ and people in the street quieter.
5. The apartment buildings are close to the city's services and _____.
6. The architects plan to build another forest city in _____ in the future.

Read again and answer the questions.

1. What are the four problems of life in central Milan that the writer mentions?

2. How do the *Bosco Verticale* buildings solve these problems?

3. What is the main problem with buildings like *Bosco Verticale*?

4. Does the writer think forest cities are a good idea?

Personal opinion: Answer the following questions.

Do you want to see forest cities in your country? Why/Why not?

Should we pay more to live in clean cities? Why/Why not?
